Figure 2.15 Team topologies of the governance team

As you can see, the enabling team will be extremely busy throughout the transformation. Let's look at the development cycle this team will support.

2.3.4 Development cycle in detail

The data mesh development cycle is focused on achieving business goals by using data. The cycle includes a definition of the goal, data required to achieve it, development itself, and, if the situation requires it, adjustment of the data governance environment or central platform modification.

It probably won't be the case in the early data mesh development stages, but when your data mesh spans multiple domains, each domain will have its own development cycle. These domains will, however, have to align their development with the works of central teams: data government and platform.

CHOOSE A BUSINESS GOAL TO ENABLE WITH DATA

We described the drivers, which may help you identify the pain points you may wish to remove when using a data mesh. However, just naming them may not be enough. To describe your business goal in sufficient detail, you need to understand the objectives of defining it.

First, you need to explain why you think it is even worth achieving your goal. What is the added value to the business? Your goal could be described using one of the frameworks—for example, OKR or SMART (which stands for specific, measurable, attainable, relevant, and time-based).

Second, you need to make sure your goal is presented in the context of the work required to achieve it. And we are not talking only about balancing the benefits of achieving the goal and the effort needed to achieve it. Teams engaged in your project will need to be able to relate their tasks to the goal in front of them. Achieving the goal should be the final factor in deciding whether a team should pick up a given task and, if so, with what priority.

Third, your business goal should have an associated responsibility assignment matrix—such as RACI (responsible, accountable, consulted, and